hanomics' was focused on rights-based economics that worked towards ensuring entitlements for the individual, especially those belonging to the weaker sections. 'Modinomics' is about ensuring fiscal prudence, with massive investment-led development and welfare schemes. It is also about harnessing technology to ensure that beneficiaries get cash transfers directly rather than via intermediaries, making delivery efficient and free of corruption. A clear thread unites Modi's actions and schemes, all of which add up to a larger gameplan that may not be evident at first but reveals itself once all the parts are in place.

In his interview to INDIA TODAY in January, the prime minister talked of exactly this "progressive unfolding"

The JAM trinity helped bank the unbanked, directed cash benefits into their accounts and made India a global leader in digital public infrastructure

of his vision. And one of the examples he cited was the massively successful public digital infrastructure that his government had instituted. In his first term, Modi had launched a major drive to bank the unbanked through the Jan Dhan scheme, which saw over 500 million people open bank accounts. He then followed it up with directing the cash transfers for sundry government welfare schemes into these beneficiary accounts with the Aadhaar card as the basis of identification and the mobile number for digital payments. Called the JAM or Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile trinity, it has proved to be a game-changer, with these accounts boasting over Rs 2.32 lakh crore as their current balance.

HIT DISINVESTMENT

THE MORALE BOOSTERS

Air India's sale and LIC's debut on the bourses signal a promising trajectory for India's privatisation goals



AP

MISS ASSET MONETISATION

A Slow Going

Despite ambitious plans of outright asset sale or privatisation, the government has fallen short of meeting its asset monetisation target, facing hurdles in implementation

A CATCHY PHRASE THAT HAD RESONATED WITH THE ELECTORATE when Prime Minister Narendra Modi took over in 2014 was "minimum government and maximum governance". It was widely expected at the time that the government would cede control of some key public sector assets through outright sale of equity, or bring in more private participation into the operation and management of such assets and enterprises to make them more productive and profitable. But there was precious little the government achieved in its first term, spending much of its energies on welfare schemes for the rural poor to counter the Opposition jibe of being a 'suit-boot *ki sarkar*'.

In August 2021, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced